Horizon International School

Code of Conduct

School Purpose

Our Vision

We, at Horizon International School, guarantee an environment that encourages the students to acquire excellent education, focusing on quality not quantity, taking into consideration the significance of their Arabic culture and increase their participation in an increasingly global society.

Mission Statement of Horizon international school

To guarantee an environment that fosters the students to acquire an excellent education, the school staff will use a variety of approaches to achieve the following beliefs:

1. producing a quality service, including quality education, programs and activities, that participates in developing both the individual and the community,
2. elegantly enhancing the religious and ethical values among the culturally differentiated students,
3. involving all the stakeholders in the school's program and process.

Our Beliefs/ Values

Our school is a place where everyone pays a close attention to highly valued excellence. We are concentrated on the values that push the quality of our work toward the top of the pyramid of education. We are:

- a source of a highly estimated work constructed to develop the personal and educational skills of the students
- a complementary role of the family's work
- a role model for the students and the community
- a place of constructing the students' dreams and their attainment
- a workshop where we appropriate the international curriculum to our own culture

School-wide Learner's outcomes

We expect our students to graduate from our school holding the appropriate characteristics that enable them to adapt to the real life in a perfect way. Our students are expected to be :

- creative
- problem solvers
- global citizens
- excellent communicators

Introduction

A school is a place that promotes responsibility, respect, civility and academic excellence in a safe learning and teaching environment. All students, parents, teachers and staff have the right to be safe, and feel safe, in their school community. With this right comes the responsibility to be law abiding citizens and to be accountable for actions that put at risk the safety of others or oneself. The HorizonInternational School Code of Conduct sets clear standards of behavior. It specifies the mandatory

consequences for student actions that do not comply with these standards. The clearly set standards of behavior apply not only to students, but also to all individuals involved in the school system – parents or guardians, volunteers, teachers and other staff members – whether they are on school property, on school buses, or at school-authorized events or activities.

Guiding Principles

• All participants involved in the school system – students, parents or guardians, volunteers, teachers and other staff members –are included in this Code of Conduct whether they are on school property, on school buses, or at school-authorized events or activities.

• All members of the school community are to be treated with respect and dignity, especiallypersons in positions of authority.

• Responsible school citizenship involves appropriate participation in the civic life of the schoolcommunity. Active and engaged citizens are aware of their rights, but more importantly, they accept responsibility for protecting their rights and the rights of others.

• Members of the school community are expected to use non-violent means to resolve conflict. Physically aggressive behavior is not a responsible way to interact with others.

• The possession, use, or threatened use of any object to injure another person endangers thesafety of oneself and others.

• Alcohol and illegal drugs are addictive and present a health hazard. Horizon International School will work cooperatively with police and drug and alcohol agencies to promote prevention strategies and, where necessary, respond to school members who are in possession of, or under the influence of, alcohol or illegal drugs.

• Insults, disrespect, and other hurtful acts disrupt learning and teaching in a school community. Members of the school community have a responsibility to maintain an environment where conflict and difference can be addressed in amanner characterized by respect and civility.

Roles and Responsibilities

1. School Boards

They provide directions to their schools thatensure opportunity, excellence, and accountability inthe education system.

They are to:

• develop policies that set out how their schoolswill implement and enforce the Code of Conduct and all other rules that they develop as related to the standards for respect,civility, responsible citizenship, and physicalsafety.

• seek input from school committees and review thesepolicies regularly with students, staff, parents orguardians, volunteers, and the community.

• establish a process that clearly communicates the Code of Conduct to all parents,students, andstaff in a manner that ensures theircommitment and support.

• ensure an effective intervention strategy andresponse to all infractions related to the standardsfor respect, civility, responsible citizenship,and physical safety.

• provide opportunities for all staff to acquire theknowledge, skills, and attitudes necessary todevelop and maintain academic excellence andsafe learning and teaching environments.

Principals

Under the direction of their school board, theytake a leadership role in the daily operation of a school.

They provide this leadership by:

• demonstrating care and commitment to academicexcellence and a safe teaching andlearning environment.

•holding everyone, under their authority, accountable for their behavior and actions.

• communicating regularly and meaningfully with all members of their school community.

Teachers and school staff

Under the leadership oftheir principals, they maintain order in the school and are expected to hold everyone to the highest standard ofrespectful and responsible behavior.

As role models,staff upholds these high standards when they:

• help students work to their full potential anddevelop their self-worth.
• communicate regularly and meaningfully withparents
• maintain consistent standards of behavior for all students.
• demonstrate respect for all students, staff, andparents.
• prepare students for the full responsibilities ofcitizenship.

Students

They are to be treated with respect and dignity. Inreturn, they must demonstrate respect for themselves,for others and for the responsibilities of citizenshipthrough acceptable behavior.

Respectand responsibilityare demonstrated when a student:

• comes to school prepared, on time, and ready to learn.
• shows respect for themselves, for others, and forthose in authority.
• refrains from bringing anything to school thatmay compromise the safety of others.
• follows the established rules and takes responsibilityfor his or her own action.

Parents

They play an important role in the education oftheir children and have a responsibility to supportthe efforts of school staff in maintaining a safe andrespectful learning environment for all students.

Parents fulfill this responsibility when they:

- show an active interest in their child's schoolwork and progress;
- communicate regularly with the school;
- help their child be neat, appropriately dressedand prepared for school;
- ensure that their child attends school regularlyand on time;
- promptly report to the school their child'sabsence or late arrival;
- become familiar with the Code of Conduct andschool rules;
- encourage and assist their child in following the rules of behavior;
- assist school staff in dealing with disciplinaryissues.

Police and community members

They are essential partnersin making our schools and communities safer.Community members need to support and respectthe rules of their local schools. Police investigateincidents in accordance with the protocol developedwith the local school board.

Standards of Behavior

Respect, civility, and responsiblecitizenship

All school members must:

- respect and comply with all applicable federal,provincial, and municipal laws.
- demonstrate honesty and integrity.
- respect differences in people, their ideas, andopinions.
- treat one another with dignity and respect at alltimes, and especially when there is disagreement.
- respect and treat others fairly, regardless oftheir race, ancestry, place of origin, color, ethnicorigin, citizenship, religion, gender, sexualorientation, age, or disability.
- respect the rights of others.

• show proper care and regard for school propertyand the property of others.
• take appropriate measures to help those in need.
• respect persons who are in a position ofauthority.
• respect the need of others to work in anenvironment of learning and teaching.

Physical Safety

Weapons

All school members must:
• not be in possession of any weapon, includingbut not limited to firearms.
• not use any object to threaten or intimidateanother person.
• not cause injury to any person with an object.

Physical Aggression

All school members must:
• not inflict or encourage others to inflict bodilyharm on another person.
• seek staff assistance, if necessary, to resolveconflict peacefully.

Mandatory Consequences

Police will be involved, as indicated by thepolice/school protocol, and the student will beimmediately suspended and proceed to an expulsionhearing for the following:

• possession of a weapon, including, but notlimited to firearms.
• robbery.
• use of a weapon to cause bodily harm, or tothreaten serious harm.
• physical assault causing bodily harm requiringprofessional medical treatment.

Immediate Suspension will be the minimumpenalty faced by a student for:

- uttering a threat to inflict serious bodily harm.
- Possession of illegal drugs.
- acts of vandalism causing extensive damage toschool property or property located on schoolpremises.In these instances, police will be involved, asrequired, and conditions to return to school will bespecified in accordance with school board policies.

A student will be immediately suspended for:

- swearing at a teacher, or other person inauthority.

Safe Environment Policy

It is part of the school vision to guarantee an environment that fosters the students to acquire en excellent education appropriately. Accordingly, the school is setting a complete system that ensures the following points:

- The playground floor is carpeted with a rubber blanket that is 12cm thick and high-temperature proof.
- 27 fire hydrants are available at the school campus.
- Every section has an active fire alarm.
- A fire system is installed in every room.
- The roof has been changed from fake ceiling into concrete cement.
- Every classroom has a wide window, along with an air condition.
- Any bas or post in the playground is covered with rubber to protect students from injuries.
- In every science laboratory, a sink, and a portable sand box are available.
- All the chemical materials are kept out of the reach of the students.
- Teachers are committed to their duties to assure the students' safety during breaks.
- Break times for lower grades is separated from the upper grades break times to avoid jam and injuries.
- A complete first aid kit is available.
- A fire hose is available as well.
- The roof is slanting slightly to give air passage to the building.
- A path is set for the Rain water to float outside the campus.
- The playground of both sections is covered with a roof for protection from sun heat.
- A net is surrounding the schools' atmosphere to prevent dust.

Healthcare Policy

The school is aware of maintaining the students' physical and mental health since it is vital for all students to live in a healthy atmosphere that helps in acquiring an excellent education. To put this vision in implementation, the school considers the points below:

- The school doesn't provide a nurse, yet the students' supervisor performs the nursing process. He holds a certificate in first aid course.
- A mini fridge contains medicine for injuries and emergencies such as bruises, wounds, fever, and stomachaches.
- Every injury or sickness case is treated seriously, the student is sent to hospital on the school bus if needed, and parents are informed immediately.
- The classrooms' floors, corridors, and bathrooms are cleaned and sterilized frequently every day.
- Liquid soap and cleaners are provided daily
- Teachers are aware about cautioning students about general and personal cleanliness through lectures.
- Teachers are always alert for their students' personal cleanliness.

Discipline Code

To maintain an environment that fosters the students to acquire an excellent education, both the teachers and the students are required to be committed to the school rules that ensure respect in every corner of the school. Any misbehavior is treated seriously by the administration to keep on the healthy atmosphere of the whole school.

The knowledge of the school rules and regulations is the responsibility of the students and teachers, and any violation will send the doer under the process of investigation and remedy. Every member of the school is accountable of knowing and respecting the rules and regulation of the school.

Some of the School Rules and Regulations:

1. **Students demonstrate respect for others, their property and themselves.**
2. **Students acknowledge and support everyone's right to learn.**
3. **Students take responsibility for their own learning and actions.**
4. **Students take responsibility for their punctuality and preparation.**
5. **Students demonstrate pride in their school.**
6. **Students are aware of Safety**.
7. **Students take responsibility for Cleanliness**

Unacceptable student behavior may include:

1. **use of drugs, alcohol, tobacco**
2. **bullying, fighting, and harassment**
3. **refusal to comply with the direct teacher commands**
4. **inappropriate bus behavior**
5. **possession of a dangerous weapon**
6. **repeated tardiness**
7. **repetitive unacceptable classroom behavior**
8. **incomplete assignments**
9. **vandalism**

Discipline Procedures

Discipline Procedures Take orderly steps:

It is the responsibility of the teacher to make correction and finish the problem inside the classroom, yet if the problem was extended outside the classroom, the following steps take place:

1. Teacher conference with student
2. Correction- preferably given in private and in kindness, sincerity and firmness by the teacher
3. Administration /teacher conference
4. Administration / students conference
5. Administration/ teacher/student conference
6. Administration/ teacher/ parent conference
7. Detention
8. In school suspension
9. Suspension from school for a period of time

Dress Code

To maintain discipline, students are requested to come to school wearing the school uniform every day. Commitment to the school uniform shows the student's respect to the school rules and regulation. **Unity of the school members, love and loyalty to the school system are all purposes of establishing such a policy.**

Only those who have a P.E. period are excepted from the rule.

Attendance and Absence

Basic Rule

Attendance on a daily basis is a mandatory requirement for all students. All students must be present at 6:45 am. to attend the assembly and then start the first period at 7:00 am. The school day ends at 12: 55 pm.

Absence

Parents are expected to contact their child's school on the day of the child's absence to inform the school of that absence. Any notification from the parents about their child's absence will enlist the absence as an excused absence. The school administration considers the following kinds absence as **excused.**

a. **Illness:** when a student faild to attend school because of illness, the parent is responsible for contacting and informing the school about that absence.
b. **Chronic/ extended illness:** When the absence of the student need more than one single day due to an extended illness, parents are to bring an written permit from an official hospital indicating that his/her child's long absence is essential.
c. **Family death or emergency (may God forbid):** In this case the parent or any of the student's relatives has to inform the school**.**
d. **Religious Observances:** Absence as a result of religious holidays should be prearranged with the school administration by the parents.
e. **Travel:** If the family is in a vital reason for travelling aboard, the parents have to inform the school at least one day before the travel.

Unexcused Absence:

When a student fails to report to the school and no indication has been received by the school, that absence is consider unexcused, and the student loses all his rights of the make- up work.

Tardiness

Students come to school late are to be asked by the administration. If there is no reasonable excuse is reported, a punishment might fall on the student, and his/ her parents will be informed.

Make-up Work

Whether the absence is excused or not, quizzes, tests, and exams will NEVER be repeated. An overall evaluation takes place instead.

The student has the right to receive all the sheets that have been given to class during his/ her absence. The teacher rearranges his/ her schedule to compensate the loss of classes the student achieves during his/her absence.

Dress Code

To maintain discipline, students are requested to come to school wearing the school uniform every day. Teachers are also obliged to wear decent uniform that represents their respectful position as role models for the students in commitment to decency and respectful appearance. Commitment to the school uniform shows the student's respect to the school rules and regulation. **Unity of the school members, love and loyalty to the school system are all purposes of establishing such a policy.**

Assembly Rules

- Every teacher is to stand in front of his class with a decent gesture.
- Every teacher should keep his/her eyes on the students to make sure they are attentive to the school broadcast.
- The teacher should look active and fresh.
- No hot or soft drinks are allowed during the assembly.
- No side talks are allowed.
- No cellphone to be used.